

U.S. Beginnings

Unit 1 study guide

Colonial America • Revolution • Creating a republic

Built around the Unit 1 Review Sheet and all ten worksheet photos in this folder. Online sources supply missing background and clarify inaccurate or oversimplified notes. The seven teacher-provided writing prompts are reproduced with model responses. Practice questions are newly written for this guide, not predictions of the test.

The story of the unit

Different colonial societies developed traditions of local government. British attempts to tighten control helped unite resistance. Independence then created a new problem: how to build a government strong enough to act but limited enough to protect liberty.

How to use this guide

1. Learn the regional comparisons and the cause-and-effect sequence. For each event, explain both what happened and why it mattered.
2. Recite the three branches, constitutional principles, and ten amendments without looking.
3. Practice all seven short-response prompts. Your review sheet says the test will ask for about half a page on one of them.
4. Complete the practice questions before checking the answer key. Review the sections behind any missed answers.

Navigation

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Source key: Photo references identify the supplied worksheets. [S1], [S2], and similar labels refer to the linked references at the end. Facts and interpretations are paraphrased unless quotation marks appear.

Scope: The visible top worksheet in each photograph is covered. Partially hidden sheets underneath cannot be reconstructed. Textbook pages mentioned on the worksheets were not present as separate files.

1. Settlement and self-government

Pilgrims, Puritans, and the Mayflower Compact

Pilgrims versus Puritans

Question	Pilgrims	Massachusetts Bay Puritans
Religious position	Core religious group was Separatist: it had broken from the Church of England. Not every Mayflower passenger was a Separatist.	Wanted to purify or reform the Church of England; built a community governed by their religious ideals.
Why leave England?	Escape religious persecution; many first lived in the Netherlands before the voyage to America.	Escape religious pressure and establish a model Christian community.
Where and when?	Plymouth, in present-day Massachusetts, 1620.	Massachusetts Bay, especially Boston and nearby towns; major migration began in 1630.
People to recognize	William Bradford, a leading Plymouth governor.	John Winthrop, a leading Massachusetts Bay governor.

Shared feature: Both sought freedom to practice their own faith. This did not mean equal religious freedom for everyone. Massachusetts Bay punished some dissenters; Rhode Island became an important alternative for religious dissent.

Mayflower Compact: answer the worksheet's three questions

What reasons did the settlers give for founding the colony? Their document names religious purposes, honor to king and country, and the colony's collective welfare. It reflects the language and priorities of its time.

Why establish a government? The settlers needed order, cooperation, and rules in a new settlement. Their landing was outside the area authorized by their original patent. The agreement bound its signers into a political community and committed them to obey its laws.

What democratic ideas appear? Government rests on an agreement among the participants; laws should serve the community; members accept obligations as well as benefits. It is an early example of colonial self-government and consent, not a declaration of independence from England.

Read the primary source accurately

Worksheet phrase	Meaning and significance
"civil body politic"	A community organized to govern itself.
"just and equal laws"	An aspiration to fair common rules, rather than arbitrary individual commands.
"general good of the Colony"	The government should work for the community's welfare.
covenant / ordinances / meet	Agreement or solemn promise / rules / fitting or suitable.

Limit: Adult male signers made the agreement. It did not establish universal voting rights, include Indigenous peoples as equal political participants, or create today's democracy. It also affirmed loyalty to the English king.

Recall: Pilgrims = Plymouth, 1620, separation. Puritans = Massachusetts Bay, 1630, reform/model community.

Sources: IMG_7201, IMG_7207, IMG_7208; [S1-S3].

2. The three colonial regions

Know all thirteen colonies and explain the patterns

Feature	New England	Middle	Southern
Colonies	Massachusetts, New Hampshire, Rhode Island, Connecticut	New York, New Jersey, Pennsylvania, Delaware	Maryland, Virginia, North Carolina, South Carolina, Georgia
Geography	Rocky soil; colder climate; short growing season; forests and good harbors	Generally fertile soil; moderate growing season; navigable rivers and ports	Longer growing season; fertile coastal areas; rivers useful for transportation
Economy	Small farms, fishing, whaling, shipbuilding, timber, shipping, commerce	Grain farming, milling, trade, crafts, and some iron production; a mixed economy	Export agriculture: tobacco in the Chesapeake; rice and indigo in the Lower South; small farms as well as plantations
People and religion	Many English settlers; strong Puritan influence in Massachusetts and Connecticut, with important dissenting communities	Relatively diverse European backgrounds and Christian denominations; Quaker influence in Pennsylvania	English settlers and others; large enslaved African population; Anglican influence in several colonies; Maryland began partly as a Catholic refuge
Community	Many compact towns; town meetings; schooling encouraged partly for Bible reading	Farms plus major commercial towns such as Philadelphia and New York; relatively greater religious diversity	More dispersed rural settlements; plantation elites held substantial power; fewer locally accessible public schools

Geography -> work -> community

New England: Limited farmland encouraged a combination of small-scale agriculture and ocean-related work. Towns supported shared churches, schools, and local meetings.

Middle colonies: Productive farmland supplied grain for regional and Atlantic markets. Rivers and ports connected farms to cities. Economic opportunity and comparatively greater religious tolerance attracted immigrants.

Southern colonies: Climate and waterways supported cash-crop exports. Plantation agriculture increased demand for coerced labor and concentrated wealth, though many settlers lived on small farms.

Labor and slavery

Indentured servants generally owed labor for a fixed term under a contract, often in exchange for passage. **Enslaved people** were held as property, usually for life, and slavery became hereditary and racialized. These systems were not equivalent.

Slavery existed in all three regions by the eve of the Revolution, with especially extensive plantation slavery in the South. Northern merchants and ports also participated in and profited from the Atlantic slave economy. Indigenous societies already inhabited these lands; colonization brought displacement, warfare, and disease.

Map reminder: Use the thirteen colonial units, not a present-day state list. Maine was part of Massachusetts; Vermont was not one of the thirteen colonies. Colonial borders did not exactly match today's borders.

Avoid: Calling New England a mechanized industrial economy. For this period, emphasize maritime commerce, skilled production, and small farms. Also, Southern religious freedom was not universal.

Sources: IMG_7201, IMG_7208, IMG_7209; [S4-S5].

3. Comparing colonial societies

Similarities, differences, and an emerging identity

Four strong similarities

- 1. **British imperial connection:** By the eve of the Revolution, all thirteen belonged to Britain's empire and were affected by its trade and political policies.
- 2. **Agriculture and Atlantic commerce:** All farmed and traded, even though the principal products and scale of production differed.
- 3. **Local political experience:** Colonial assemblies and other local institutions created expectations of self-government. Political participation was restricted, often by property, sex, race, and religion.
- 4. **Unequal societies:** Slavery, unequal access to power, and settlement on Indigenous lands were part of colonial life across regions.

Four differences worth explaining

Difference	Useful comparison
Economic specialization	New England maritime trades; Middle grain and commerce; Southern cash-crop exports.
Settlement and education	Compact New England towns supported local schools; dispersed Southern settlements made public schooling less accessible.
Religious and cultural patterns	Puritan influence in much of New England; greater diversity in the Middle colonies; Anglican influence and other traditions in the South.
Geography and labor	Climate and soil affected crops; large Southern plantations relied especially heavily on enslaved labor.

Why might immigrants choose the Middle colonies?

Relatively fertile land offered farming opportunities. Ports and towns created jobs in trade and crafts. Religious tolerance in places such as Pennsylvania appealed to groups facing restrictions elsewhere. Existing communities of different languages and faiths could provide social support. These were opportunities for voluntary migrants; forced migration through slavery was a fundamentally different experience.

Had the colonies become one American society by 1775?

Best answer: partly, but not completely. Common grievances against Parliament encouraged intercolonial cooperation through petitions, boycotts, committees of correspondence, and Continental Congresses. Shared ideas about rights gave Patriots common language.

Regional economic interests, religious practices, and loyalties to individual colonies remained strong. Loyalists opposed independence, and other people tried to avoid choosing sides. A developing political alliance did not erase social differences or create equal rights for all.

Model claim for IMG_7209: By the Revolution, the colonies had developed enough shared political interests to resist Britain together, but they had not become a single uniform society. Their cooperation grew out of common grievances despite continuing regional and social divisions.

Correction: Do not answer this 1775 question by jumping to the Civil War. Explain the degree of unity at the time the question asks about. Nor were all inhabitants newly arrived immigrants: many were locally born, and Indigenous peoples were not immigrants to their own homelands.

Self-check: Name the thirteen colonies by region, then give one economic similarity, two differences, and one event that promoted unity.

Sources: IMG_7208, IMG_7209; [S4-S6].

4. Why resistance developed

Ideas, imperial war, and the first new taxes

Ideas that made authority open to challenge

Enlightenment: Emphasized reason and inquiry. John Locke's ideas included natural rights, consent of the governed, and a right to resist a government that violated its purposes. Montesquieu's separation of powers helped shape later constitutional thinking.

First Great Awakening: Religious revivals, especially in the 1730s-1740s, emphasized personal conversion. Jonathan Edwards and George Whitefield were prominent figures. Revivals created networks across colonies and challenged some established religious authorities. They also divided communities; they were a background influence rather than a single direct cause of independence.

Connection: Both movements could encourage questioning established authority, but one emphasized reason and political philosophy while the other emphasized religious experience.

Road to Revolution, part I

Event	What happened?	Why did it matter?
French and Indian War, 1754-1763	Britain and its colonial allies fought France and its allies in North America; Native nations made differing alliances. Britain won.	War debt and the cost of defense led Britain to seek more colonial revenue and control.
Proclamation of 1763	Britain restricted colonial settlement beyond the Appalachian boundary.	Settlers and land speculators resented limits on western expansion; Britain sought to reduce frontier conflict.
Sugar Act, 1764	Parliament revised duties, including lowering the molasses rate, while enforcing collection more strictly.	Merchants opposed burdensome enforcement and taxation without their elected colonial assemblies' consent.
Stamp Act, 1765	Required a paid stamp on many printed and legal materials.	Broad opposition led to protests, boycotts, and the Stamp Act Congress, promoting cooperation.
Repeal and Declaratory Act, 1766	Parliament repealed the Stamp Act but asserted broad authority over the colonies.	The immediate tax disappeared; the argument over sovereignty remained.
Townshend duties, 1767	Import duties on items including glass, paper, paint, lead, and tea, with stronger customs enforcement.	New boycotts and resistance; troop presence in Boston worsened tensions.

The deeper dispute

Britain argued that colonists should help pay imperial expenses and obey Parliament. Many colonists argued that taxes should require consent through representatives they elected. They had no elected representatives in Parliament. **No taxation without representation** was therefore about political authority as well as money.

Unity mechanisms: Boycotts put economic pressure on British merchants; petitions stated shared grievances; the Sons of Liberty organized resistance; women participated through nonconsumption and homespun production. Committees of correspondence later helped communities exchange information.

Sources: IMG_7205; [S6-S9].

5. From protest to independence

Follow the escalation, not just the dates

Event	What happened?	Unity and tension
Boston Massacre, March 5, 1770	British soldiers fired during a confrontation in Boston, killing five colonists.	Patriot accounts and images portrayed British troops as a threat to liberty. Propaganda helped shape opinion.
Committees of correspondence, especially 1772-1773	Local and intercolonial networks circulated political news and arguments.	Turned separate grievances into coordinated resistance.
Tea Act and Boston Tea Party, 1773	Parliament favored the East India Company's tea sales while retaining the existing colonial tea duty. On December 16, protesters destroyed tea in Boston Harbor.	Colonists objected to Parliament's authority and the company's advantage over colonial merchants.
Intolerable / Coercive Acts, 1774	Britain punished Massachusetts, including closing Boston's port and limiting self-government.	Other colonies feared similar treatment and rallied to Massachusetts.
First Continental Congress, 1774	Delegates from twelve colonies met in Philadelphia; Georgia did not attend. They coordinated resistance, including a boycott.	Intercolonial organization grew. This Congress did not issue the Declaration of Independence.
Lexington and Concord, April 19, 1775	British troops sought military supplies in Massachusetts; colonial militia resisted.	Armed war began before a formal declaration of independence.
Second Continental Congress, May 1775 onward	Coordinated the war effort, created the Continental Army, and selected Washington to command it.	Began acting as a national government while reconciliation was still debated.
Common Sense, January 1776	Thomas Paine's pamphlet attacked monarchy and argued for independence in accessible language.	Helped persuade readers that a complete break was desirable.
Declaration of Independence, July 4, 1776	Congress adopted the explanation and assertion of separation from Britain.	Made independence the official common goal of the colonies represented in Congress.

Why did many colonists eventually want independence?

Repeated taxation and interference with self-government convinced many that their rights would not be secure within the empire. Punitive policies and armed conflict weakened hopes of reconciliation. Arguments such as Paine's made monarchy itself a target. The change was gradual: protesting a tax in 1765 did not automatically mean supporting independence then.

Tea Act trap: The law did not introduce a brand-new colonial tea tax. Its trade advantages could make company tea cheaper, but an existing duty and the dispute over Parliament's authority remained.

First versus Second Congress: First = organized resistance in 1774. Second = directed the war beginning in 1775 and adopted independence in 1776.

Cause chain: Debt and tighter control -> protests and boycotts -> punishment and coordination -> armed conflict -> independence.

Sources: IMG_7205, IMG_7206, IMG_7201; [S6-S7, S10-S11].

6. The American Revolution

Required events and their significance

Date and event	What to know	Why it matters
April 19, 1775: Lexington and Concord, Massachusetts	British troops marched to seize colonial military supplies. Militia fought them; fighting continued during the British retreat. Minutemen were militia prepared to mobilize quickly.	Beginning of the Revolutionary War.
May-June 1775: Second Continental Congress	Congress organized the Continental Army and appointed George Washington commander.	Gave the colonies a common military effort and coordinating political body.
June 17, 1775: Bunker Hill, Massachusetts	Much fighting occurred on Breed's Hill. Britain took the position, but suffered heavy casualties.	A British tactical victory that showed colonial forces could impose a high cost.
July 4, 1776: Declaration of Independence	Congress adopted the Declaration, chiefly drafted by Thomas Jefferson and revised by the committee and Congress.	Asserted independence and explained its justification.
September-October 1777: Saratoga, New York	American forces defeated Burgoyne's campaign; he surrendered on October 17.	Major turning point: strengthened the case for an open French alliance.
February 1778: French alliance	France recognized and allied with the United States.	Money, supplies, troops, and naval power changed the balance.
October 19, 1781: Yorktown, Virginia	Washington's and French forces trapped Cornwallis's army; French naval power blocked escape or reinforcement by sea.	Decisive major British surrender; helped bring peace negotiations.
September 3, 1783: Treaty of Paris	Britain formally recognized U.S. independence. Boundaries extended west to the Mississippi, with Canada to the north and Spanish Florida to the south.	Formally ended the war between Britain and the United States.

Three distinctions to memorize

Start: Lexington and Concord, 1775. **Turning point:** Saratoga, 1777. **Decisive major surrender:** Yorktown, 1781. **Formal peace:** Treaty of Paris, 1783.

Declaration versus war: The Declaration was not the start of fighting and is better described as a declaration of independence than as a declaration of war.

Two Treaties of Paris: 1763 ended the French and Indian/Seven Years' War; 1783 recognized American independence. Do not swap them.

Supporting context

Washington's victories at Trenton and Princeton in late 1776 and early 1777 revived morale. At Valley Forge in 1777-1778, shortages and disease tested the army, while training and organizational improvements strengthened it. These supplement the named events on your review sheet.

Casualty caution: Learn outcomes and significance first. Some handwritten totals in the battle worksheet are unclear; do not memorize them as verified figures.

Sources: IMG_7201, IMG_7203; [S6, S12-S14].

7. How the Americans won

Strengths, weaknesses, and outside assistance

Side	Strengths	Weaknesses
Americans	Washington's leadership; motivation to defend homes and independence; local knowledge; ability to continue resistance across a large territory; crucial French aid	Limited revenue and supplies; uneven training and short enlistments; weak navy; difficulty coordinating states; divided public loyalties
British	Experienced professional military; powerful navy; greater financial resources; established supply systems; Loyalist assistance	Long Atlantic supply lines; difficult communications; huge territory to control; need to defeat resistance politically as well as militarily; expensive global commitments

Explain why each mattered

The Americans did not need to conquer Britain. They needed to preserve organized resistance long enough to make continued British rule impractical or too costly. British forces could capture a port or city without controlling the countryside or destroying the Continental Army.

Washington's ability to keep an army in the field mattered even after defeats. Britain's distance from the battlefield made supplying and directing forces harder. Neither side's advantages guaranteed victory; strategy, endurance, and alliances made those advantages useful.

France: connect Saratoga to Yorktown

Before the formal alliance: French assistance, including covert supplies, had already begun. Saratoga did not mark the first-ever French help.

After Saratoga: American success and diplomacy helped convince France to recognize the United States and sign treaties in 1778. France also wanted to weaken its British rival.

At Yorktown: French troops and naval forces worked with the Americans. The fleet's control of the approaches prevented British rescue by sea while the allied army besieged Cornwallis on land.

Other aid and opposition to Britain broadened the war. Spain fought Britain from 1779; Dutch support and conflict with Britain also mattered. Individuals from German states and Poland served the American cause. Do not describe all of these as identical formal alliances with the United States, or refer to a unified Germany at this time.

Divided populations

Patriots supported independence. **Loyalists** remained loyal to Britain. Other people stayed neutral or changed positions. Native nations pursued their own interests, often including protection of land. Enslaved people also made choices shaped by opportunities for freedom; people of African descent served on both sides.

Correct the worksheet shortcuts

- Local farms did not guarantee a constant food supply for the army. Purchasing, transporting, and distributing food remained major problems.
- The Continental Congress existed, but lacked reliable national fiscal and enforcement power. Say weak central coordination, not literally no government.
- Some Britons opposed the war; others supported it. Avoid describing British public opinion as unanimous.

Sources: IMG_7203, IMG_7204; [S12-S15].

8. The Declaration of Independence

Ideas that justified a new nation

Adopted: July 4, 1776, by the Second Continental Congress. **Main drafter:** Thomas Jefferson, working within a committee; Congress revised the text. **Purpose:** Explain why the colonies were separating and assert their status as independent states.

Follow the argument in four steps

- 1. People possess inherent rights, including life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness.
- 2. Government exists to protect rights, and legitimate authority depends on the consent of the governed.
- 3. A sustained pattern of abuse can justify altering or replacing a government; the argument is not that every minor disagreement justifies revolution.
- 4. The document accuses the king of repeated abuses and declares the colonies free and independent states.

Answer the document-analysis questions

Question	Strong answer
What is the purpose of government?	To secure people's rights, drawing legitimate authority from their consent.
What justifies revolution?	A persistent pattern of destructive or tyrannical government, after efforts to obtain relief have failed.
What wrongs does the document allege?	Interference with representative bodies, obstruction of laws and justice, taxation without consent, military coercion, and denial of legal protections.
What solution does it announce?	Political separation from Britain and the powers of independent states, including making war, peace, alliances, and trade.
Who is the audience?	Colonists, British authorities, and a wider world whose recognition or assistance the Americans sought.

Philosophical foundation versus government structure

The Declaration explains **why legitimate government exists** and **why independence is justified**. The Constitution later specifies **how the national government is organized**. The Declaration did not create the presidency, the Supreme Court, or the three-branch system.

Its principles helped define a lasting standard against which governments could be judged. They also exposed contradictions: slavery continued, women lacked equal political rights, and Indigenous peoples were excluded from the new political community. Stating equality did not immediately make society equal.

How to analyze a source in a short response

Identify: What is it, who produced it, and when? **Contextualize:** What problem or conflict prompted it? **Use evidence:** Refer to a specific idea or grievance. **Explain:** Show how that evidence supports your answer, rather than merely restating it.

Practice claim: The Declaration helped establish the philosophical foundation of American government by connecting political legitimacy to rights and consent. Later constitutional institutions attempted to organize government around limited public authority, even as major exclusions persisted.

Do not confuse the authors: Paine wrote Common Sense; Jefferson was the Declaration's main drafter; the Constitutional Convention produced the Constitution.

Sources: IMG_7201, IMG_7203, IMG_7206; [S9, S16].

9. Articles of Confederation

A government designed to prevent another powerful ruler

Confederation: An alliance of states that retains substantial state authority. The Articles were the first U.S. national constitution, adopted in 1777 and fully ratified in 1781. They remained in force until the new Constitution took effect in 1789.

Why so weak? Experience with British rule made many Americans fear concentrated national power. They trusted their states and deliberately limited the central government.

Feature	Practical consequence
One-house Congress; one vote per state	States were political equals regardless of population, but large states objected to equal voting strength.
No independent national executive	Congress lacked a separate president charged with carrying out its laws.
No general national judiciary comparable to today's federal courts	There was no separate Supreme Court and broad federal court system to enforce a uniform national framework.
Congress requested funds from states rather than directly taxing	Unreliable revenue made debt payment and military support difficult. States could tax their own residents.
No general power to regulate interstate or foreign commerce	Conflicting state policies and trade barriers weakened coordinated economic action.
Nine states required for major decisions; all thirteen for amendments	Important action was difficult, and changing the system was especially hard.

Powers and real achievements

Congress could conduct foreign relations, make treaties, decide war and peace, borrow and issue money, and direct military affairs. National institutions helped carry the war effort through independence and peace. The Land Ordinance of 1785 and Northwest Ordinance of 1787 created important systems for western land and territorial government.

Problems facing the new country

War debt and unstable finances burdened governments. Trade disputes divided states. Congress struggled to secure compliance with national decisions. Britain continued occupying frontier posts, and conflicts over western land and trade exposed weakness in diplomacy and enforcement.

Shays' Rebellion, 1786-1787

Massachusetts farmers and other debtors protested taxes, debts, and court actions that threatened their property. Armed protesters closed courts; a Massachusetts force suppressed the rebellion. The crisis heightened elite fears of disorder and the national government's weakness, strengthening support for reform. It was one major catalyst, not the only cause of the Constitutional Convention.

Important corrections: The worksheet's heading "1781-1787" compresses the story: 1787 was the Convention, while the Articles continued until 1789. Congress had military powers, so "no central army" is too absolute. The central problem was inadequate funding and enforcement. It also had procedures for some interstate disputes, so "could not settle any disagreements" is too broad.

Judgment: The Articles achieved union and important land policies, but lacked reliable powers for lasting national finance and governance.

Sources: IMG_7201, IMG_7202; [S17-S18].

10. Organizing western lands

Land Ordinance of 1785 versus Northwest Ordinance of 1787

Question	Land Ordinance, 1785	Northwest Ordinance, 1787
Main problem	How should western public land be surveyed and sold?	How should the Northwest Territory be governed and become states?
Main solution	Rectangular survey system using townships and sections.	A staged territorial government and a route to equal statehood.
Key facts	A township measured 6 miles by 6 miles: 36 square miles, divided into 36 one-square-mile sections. Section 16 was reserved to support public schools.	An appointed territorial government came first; a legislature followed once population requirements were met. Statehood generally required 60,000 free inhabitants.
Lasting importance	Orderly land sales, public revenue, and support for education.	New states could join on equal terms with existing states rather than remain permanent subordinate colonies.

What was the Northwest Territory?

The region lay north of the Ohio River and east of the Mississippi, south of the Great Lakes. It eventually became Ohio, Indiana, Illinois, Michigan, Wisconsin, and part of Minnesota. This is the Old Northwest, not the modern Pacific Northwest.

Rights and limits of the Northwest Ordinance

The ordinance provided protections including religious liberty and legal rights and encouraged education. It prohibited slavery in the territory while also providing for the return of fugitives from enslavement. It promised fair treatment of Native peoples, yet American expansion repeatedly undermined Indigenous land rights and sovereignty.

Why these laws matter to an Articles essay

They show that the Confederation government was not a total failure. It could create lasting policies even while struggling to raise money or enforce its decisions. A strong evaluation recognizes these accomplishments before explaining why national reform was still needed.

Remember the difference

1785 = survey and sell. 1787 = govern and admit. Both were passed under the Articles of Confederation. Neither should be confused with the Constitution, which was also written in 1787.

Apply it

A surveyor divides a township into square parcels: Land Ordinance of 1785.

Settlers seek admission as a state on equal terms: Northwest Ordinance of 1787.

Congress lacks tax income but seeks money from western land sales: Connect the Articles' revenue weakness to the Land Ordinance.

A question asks whether westward settlement benefited everyone: Explain the opportunities for settlers alongside the displacement and dispossession of Native communities. Territory on a U.S. map was not empty land.

Sources: Topics required by IMG_7201; [S19-S20].

11. Creating the Constitution

Representation, compromise, and ratification

Constitutional Convention: Philadelphia, 1787. Delegates gathered to address the Articles' problems but produced a new framework. George Washington presided; James Madison played a major role in planning and debate. The document was signed on September 17, 1787, obtained the required ninth state ratification in 1788, and began operating in 1789.

The representation debate

Proposal	Core idea	Who benefited?
Virginia Plan	Strong national government; representation based on population or contribution, with a two-house legislature.	Larger states with more people.
New Jersey Plan	Equal state representation in a one-house legislature while revising and strengthening the existing system.	Smaller states worried about being outvoted.
Great / Connecticut Compromise	A two-house Congress: House representation apportioned by population; Senate representation equal, with two senators per state.	Balanced large-state and small-state demands.

Bicameral means two chambers. The Great Compromise was about representation of states; the Three-Fifths Compromise was a different dispute about population counting and slavery.

Three-Fifths Compromise

For apportioning House seats and direct taxes, the Constitution counted three-fifths of the enslaved population along with the free population specified in its formula. This increased slaveholding states' representation compared with excluding enslaved people entirely, without giving enslaved people voting rights. It was a political compromise that protected slavery's power, not an extension of citizenship or equality.

Ratification: Federalists versus Anti-Federalists

Federalists supported the proposed Constitution, arguing that an effective national government was necessary and its structure would restrain power. Hamilton, Madison, and John Jay defended it in The Federalist essays.

Anti-Federalists feared that the proposed national government could threaten liberty and state authority. Many demanded explicit protection of individual rights. The promise of a bill of rights helped secure ratification; the first ten amendments were ratified in 1791.

What changed from the Articles?

Congress received effective taxing and commerce powers. A separate executive could administer national law. A federal judiciary could hear cases within national jurisdiction. Constitutional amendment became possible without unanimous state approval, though it remained deliberately difficult.

Date chain: 1776 independence -> 1781 Articles fully ratified -> 1787 Constitution written -> 1788 required ratification -> 1789 new government -> 1791 Bill of Rights.

Name trap: Federalists supporting ratification in 1787-1788 and the Federalist political party of the 1790s overlap, but are not identical categories. Madison supported ratification and later opposed Hamilton's party.

Sources: IMG_7200, IMG_7202; [S21-S23, S26].

12. How the U.S. government works

Powers are divided and each branch faces limits

Branch	Who?	Main role	Powers to recognize
Legislative: Article I	Congress: House of Representatives and Senate	Makes laws	Taxes and spending; regulation of commerce; declaration of war; oversight. House seats depend on population; Senate has two per state.
Executive: Article II	President and executive officials	Enforces and administers laws	Commander in chief; vetoes legislation; negotiates treaties; nominates judges and other officers, subject to constitutional checks.
Judicial: Article III	Supreme Court and lower federal courts established by Congress	Interprets law and resolves cases	Judicial review can invalidate government action that conflicts with the Constitution.

Five essential principles

Popular sovereignty: Government's authority comes from the people. **Republican government:** People govern through elected representatives. **Limited government:** Officials are bound by law and the Constitution. **Separation of powers:** Different branches have different basic jobs. **Federalism:** Power is divided between national and state governments.

Checks and balances: name both actors

Action	Who checks whom?
President vetoes a bill	Executive checks legislative.
Two-thirds of each chamber override a veto	Legislative checks executive.
President nominates a federal judge; Senate confirms	Executive and legislative participate in selecting the judiciary.
Courts find a law or executive action unconstitutional in a case	Judicial checks legislative or executive.
House impeaches; Senate conducts the trial and can convict and remove	Legislative checks executive officials or federal judges.
President negotiates a treaty; two-thirds of senators present must consent to ratification	Legislative checks executive foreign affairs.

Three distinctions teachers often test

Separation of powers: Congress writes laws, the president carries them out, courts interpret them. **Checks and balances:** One branch limits another, such as a veto. **Federalism:** National versus state authority, such as national coinage and state/local education responsibilities. Both national and state governments may exercise some powers, such as taxation.

Impeachment is an accusation, not a conviction. The House approves charges. The Senate holds the trial; conviction requires two-thirds of senators present and results in removal. It is distinct from an ordinary criminal trial.

Correct the worksheet: The executive's main function is to enforce laws, even though presidents also propose policies. Popular sovereignty is authority from the people; separation of powers is division among branches. These labels were mixed up in the handwritten notes.

Sources: IMG_7200, IMG_7201; [S22, S27].

13. The Bill of Rights

The first ten amendments, ratified in 1791

The Bill of Rights places explicit limits on government and protects individual liberties. Learn the number, the protection, and one example. The summaries below are for history review, not a complete account of modern constitutional law.

No.	Core protection	Memory cue or example
1	Religion, speech, press, peaceful assembly, and petition; no establishment of religion and protection of free exercise.	Citizens peacefully criticize the government and petition for change.
2	Right to keep and bear arms.	Arms.
3	Limits quartering soldiers in private homes; peacetime quartering requires owner consent.	Your home is not automatically a military barracks.
4	Protection against unreasonable searches and seizures; warrants require probable cause and particular descriptions.	A vague warrant to search everyone's property is a warning sign.
5	Grand jury protection for serious federal charges, with exceptions; no double jeopardy or compelled self-incrimination; due process; compensation for public takings.	"Pleading the Fifth" concerns self-incrimination.
6	Criminal trial rights: speedy and public trial, impartial jury, notice of charges, witnesses, and counsel.	An accused person can defend against a criminal charge.
7	Jury trial in qualifying federal civil cases.	Civil disputes, as distinct from criminal prosecution.
8	No excessive bail or fines, or cruel and unusual punishment.	Limits on punishment and financial penalties.
9	Listing some rights does not deny other rights retained by the people.	Unlisted rights still matter.
10	Undelegated powers, unless prohibited to states, are reserved to states or the people.	Reserved powers and federalism.

Sort the commonly confused amendments

4 = investigation: searches and seizures. **5 = protections including silence and due process.** **6 = criminal trial.** **7 = civil jury.** **8 = punishment.** **9 = rights retained.** **10 = powers reserved.**

Why rights support democracy

Speech and press allow criticism of leaders and discussion of alternatives. Assembly and petition let people organize and ask for change. Fair-trial protections make it harder for officials to silence opponents through arbitrary punishment. Constitutional limits protect people even when their views are unpopular.

Original scope and historical limits

The Bill of Rights originally restricted the federal government. Many protections were later applied to states through interpretation of the Fourteenth Amendment. Neither the first ten amendments nor the original Constitution established equal political participation for everyone in 1791.

Do not overstate: Rights have legal limits and exceptions. The Fourth Amendment does not mean every search always requires a warrant, and the First Amendment does not make every possible act of expression immune from law.

Sources: Topic required by IMG_7201; [S23, S28].

14. Early parties and political ideas

Federalists and Democratic-Republicans in the 1790s

Disputes over how to use the new Constitution helped produce political parties. “Democratic-Republican” identifies a historical party; it does not mean a blend of the two major parties today.

Issue	Federalist Party	Democratic-Republicans
Major leaders	Alexander Hamilton; John Adams	Thomas Jefferson; James Madison
Government	Stronger national authority and energetic administration	Greater emphasis on state authority and limits on national power
Constitutional interpretation	Broader use of implied powers	Generally stricter reading of delegated federal powers
Economic vision	Commerce, manufacturing, public credit, and a national bank	An agricultural republic centered on independent farmers; suspicion of concentrated financial power
Typical support	Merchants, creditors, and commercial interests, especially in parts of the Northeast	Farmers and many southern and western voters; support also existed elsewhere
Foreign sympathies	Often favored stable commercial relations with Britain	Often more sympathetic to revolutionary France, especially early on

Apply the contrast: a national bank

Hamilton argued that a bank could help carry out the federal government's constitutional fiscal responsibilities even though the document did not explicitly name a bank. Jefferson argued that the national government should not exercise powers beyond those the Constitution authorized. This illustrates the dispute over implied powers and constitutional interpretation.

Do not mix up three debates

Patriots versus Loyalists: Independence or continued British allegiance during the Revolution.

Federalists versus Anti-Federalists: Whether to ratify the proposed Constitution in 1787-1788, and on what terms.

Federalist Party versus Democratic-Republicans: Competing programs for governing under the Constitution in the 1790s.

What do liberal and conservative mean?

In a broad classroom spectrum, **liberal** views tend to favor reform and expanded liberty or equality; **conservative** views emphasize established institutions, tradition, and caution about rapid change. A **moderate** position is nearer the center; **radical** often describes fundamental change; **reactionary** often describes restoring an earlier order.

These terms depend on time, place, and the issue. Eighteenth-century arguments for individual liberty and limited monarchy do not map neatly onto modern American party labels. Federalists are often described as relatively conservative because of their emphasis on order and established leadership, while Democratic-Republicans appealed more broadly to white male participation. Both operated within a society with major exclusions.

Exam strategy: If asked which party believed something, identify a specific policy or constitutional argument. Do not assume that “more national government” always means liberal, or that “states' rights” always means conservative in every era.

Sources: Topic required by IMG_7201; [S24-S25].

15. Teacher short responses: 1-3

Practice a claim, specific evidence, and explanation

These are the seven prompts on IMG_7201. The models demonstrate what to explain; write in your own words. For the requested half-page response, develop a clear claim with two or three specific pieces of evidence and a sentence explaining significance.

1. What was the Mayflower Compact? Why is it significant in American history?

The Mayflower Compact was a 1620 agreement among male settlers aboard the Mayflower to establish a political community and obey laws made for its common welfare. The settlers needed an agreed authority because they had arrived outside the area covered by their original permission to settle. The Compact matters because it illustrates an early colonial tradition of government based on an agreement among participants. Its commitment to common laws and collective welfare helped establish a practice of self-government. However, it was not a declaration of independence: the settlers still professed loyalty to the English king. Nor was it a modern democratic constitution, since political participation was restricted. Its significance lies in the principle that members of a community could join together to create rules and accept responsibilities for their common government.

Evidence to remember: 1620; agreement and consent; common laws; loyalty to the king; restricted participation. See p. 2.

2. Describe the similarities and differences between the 3 colonial regions.

New England, the Middle colonies, and the Southern colonies shared ties to the British Empire, agriculture, Atlantic trade, and experience with local political institutions. Slavery existed in all three regions, although its scale and economic role differed. Geography helped shape their differences. New England's rocky soil and short growing season encouraged small farms alongside fishing, shipping, and shipbuilding. The Middle colonies combined fertile grain farms with ports and crafts and had relatively diverse religious and cultural communities. The South's longer growing season and waterways supported export crops and plantations that relied heavily on enslaved labor. Settlement also differed: compact New England towns often supported local schools, while much of the South was more dispersed. The regions therefore shared imperial and political connections while developing distinct economic and social patterns.

Evidence to remember: At least two similarities and a specific example from each region. See pp. 3-4.

3. Elaborate: Why would immigrants have chosen to live in the middle colonies?

The Middle colonies could appeal to immigrants because they combined economic opportunities with relatively greater cultural and religious diversity. Fertile land supported profitable grain farming, while ports such as Philadelphia and New York offered work in trade, crafts, and transportation. Communities of different European backgrounds could help newcomers find social connections. Pennsylvania's Quaker influence and policy of greater religious tolerance also attracted some people who had faced religious restrictions elsewhere. These factors made the region attractive to farmers, tradespeople, merchants, and religious minorities. However, opportunities were unequal, and tolerance was not the same as full modern equality. This explanation concerns voluntary immigrants; enslaved Africans were forcibly transported and could not choose where to settle. Overall, the Middle colonies offered several ways to build a livelihood within a comparatively diverse society.

Evidence to remember: Fertile farmland; port jobs; Pennsylvania/Quakers; community diversity. See pp. 3-4.

Sources: Teacher prompts, IMG_7201; evidence from pp. 2-4 and their sources.

16. Teacher short responses: 4-5

Connect founding ideas to practical government

4. How did the Declaration of Independence establish the foundation of American government?

The Declaration of Independence established a philosophical foundation for American government by stating that people have inherent rights and that government's purpose is to protect them. It argued that legitimate government depends on the consent of the governed. If a government repeatedly violates its basic purposes, the people may replace it. The Declaration used these principles to explain why the colonies were justified in separating from Britain, then listed grievances to support that argument. These ideas encouraged an understanding of political power as something entrusted by the people rather than inherited by a monarch. The document did not itself create the three branches or the detailed national system; the Constitution later supplied that framework. Its ideals also exceeded the equality actually practiced in 1776, when slavery and major political exclusions continued. Nevertheless, rights and consent became standards against which later Americans could judge their government.

Build the explanation: Rights -> government's purpose -> consent -> right to replace abusive government -> later constitutional framework. See p. 9.

Common weak answer: "It made us independent." That identifies an outcome but does not explain the principles that grounded government.

5. Did the Articles of Confederation provide the United States with an effective government?

The Articles of Confederation provided a useful early union but did not create an effective long-term national government. They reflected Americans' fear of concentrated power after the struggle against Britain and left substantial authority with the states. Congress could conduct diplomacy and helped manage national affairs through the end of the war. It also produced important achievements, including the land ordinances that organized western settlement and statehood. However, it could not directly tax the population and depended on state contributions, making debts and national defense difficult to fund. It lacked a separate executive and a broad national judiciary, and the requirement of unanimous approval for amendments made reform difficult. Economic disputes and Shays' Rebellion increased concern that the country could not act effectively. These problems helped lead to the Constitutional Convention. Therefore, the Articles succeeded in cooperation and some policies but failed to provide dependable national authority.

Build the evaluation: Qualified claim -> at least one success -> at least two weaknesses -> concrete consequence -> final judgment. See pp. 10-11.

Common weak answer: "They were bad because the government was weak." Name the missing power and explain the effect: inability to tax -> unreliable revenue -> difficulty paying debts or funding defense.

Writing checklist

- Answer the question in the first sentence.
- Use the document or event's name accurately.
- Explain cause and consequence after each key fact.
- Include a limit or qualification when the question asks for evaluation.
- Avoid claiming that all colonists agreed or that founding ideals were fully realized.

Sources: Teacher prompts, IMG_7201; evidence from pp. 9-11 and their sources.

17. Teacher short responses: 6-7

Explain how institutions and rights limit power

6. Identify how the idea of 'separation of powers' is reflected in the US Constitution.

The Constitution reflects separation of powers by assigning the national government's basic functions to three branches. Article I establishes Congress, which makes laws. Article II establishes the executive headed by the president, who carries out laws. Article III establishes the judiciary, which interprets and applies laws in cases. Dividing these responsibilities makes it harder for one institution to control every stage of government. The Constitution also creates checks and balances that connect the branches while limiting them. For example, a president can veto a bill passed by Congress, but Congress can override the veto with the required two-thirds vote in each chamber. The president nominates federal judges, while the Senate must approve their appointments. Separation of powers concerns the branches' distinct responsibilities; checks and balances concern their ability to limit one another. Together, these arrangements seek to make government capable of acting without allowing unchecked concentration of power.

Evidence to remember: Articles I, II, III; make, enforce, interpret; veto/override; nomination/confirmation. See p. 13.

Keep federalism separate: National versus state government is a different division of power.

7. Choose one of the first ten amendments. Explain the right (or rights) it gives to citizens. Explain why this is important for a democratic society.

The First Amendment protects freedom of religion, speech, and the press, as well as peaceful assembly and the right to petition government. These protections are important to democracy because citizens need to discuss public issues, criticize leaders, and organize for change. A free press can investigate officials and help voters make informed decisions. Peaceful assembly and petition allow people to present shared concerns rather than rely only on powerful individuals to speak for them. Religious freedom also limits the government's ability to force people to accept an official faith. These protections make political participation more meaningful by allowing disagreement and preventing the government from simply suppressing criticism. They do not mean every form of expression is legally unlimited, but they establish strong protections for public debate. A democratic society needs those protections because elections alone cannot hold leaders accountable if people cannot discuss their actions freely.

Evidence to remember: State the amendment number; name its protections; explain how they support participation or prevent abuse. See p. 14.

Alternative choices for prompt 7

Fourth Amendment: Explain protection from unreasonable searches and seizures, then connect it to privacy and restraint of arbitrary government.

Sixth Amendment: Explain criminal-trial safeguards, then show why the government should not be able to punish an accused person without a fair chance to defend themselves.

Tenth Amendment: Explain reserved powers and the division of authority, rather than claiming that states may ignore the Constitution.

Sources: Teacher prompts, IMG_7201; evidence from pp. 13-14 and their sources.

18. Practice: core knowledge

Answer before checking pages 21-22

1. Which comparison is most accurate?

- A. Pilgrims wanted to reform the Church of England; Puritans rejected all religion.
- B. Pilgrim Separatists left the Church of England; Massachusetts Bay Puritans sought a reformed religious community.
- C. Both groups founded Virginia mainly to grow tobacco.
- D. Both immediately established universal religious and voting rights.

2. What best explains the significance of the Mayflower Compact?

- A. It separated the colonies from Britain. B. It created the U.S. Supreme Court.
- C. It made a common government rest on an agreement among its participants. D. It abolished slavery.

3. Which set lists only Middle colonies?

- A. New York, New Jersey, Pennsylvania, Delaware.
- B. Massachusetts, Maryland, Virginia, Georgia.
- C. Connecticut, Rhode Island, New Hampshire, Pennsylvania.
- D. North Carolina, South Carolina, New York, New Jersey.

4. Explain one link between geography and the economy of each colonial region.

5. Which development best explains Britain's push for more colonial revenue after 1763?

- A. U.S. independence had already been recognized. B. France had joined the Patriots.
- C. The Constitution required British taxes. D. Britain faced war debt and defense costs.

6. Which sequence is in chronological order?

- A. Tea Party -> Stamp Act -> Lexington and Concord -> Declaration.
- B. Stamp Act -> Tea Party -> Lexington and Concord -> Declaration.
- C. Declaration -> Tea Party -> Stamp Act -> Lexington and Concord.
- D. Lexington and Concord -> Stamp Act -> Declaration -> Tea Party.

7. Why could colonists object to East India Company tea even if its price fell?

8. Distinguish the First and Second Continental Congresses in one sentence each.

9. Why was Saratoga a turning point?

- A. It ended the war by treaty. B. It created the Bill of Rights.
- C. It helped bring France into a formal alliance with the United States. D. It was the first fighting of the Revolution.

10. Which statement about Bunker Hill is correct?

- A. Britain captured the position but suffered heavy casualties.
- B. France signed the peace treaty there. C. It was fought after Yorktown. D. It ended British rule immediately.

11. Explain how French naval power contributed to victory at Yorktown.

12. Identify the difference between the Declaration of Independence and the Treaty of Paris of 1783.

These are original study questions aligned to the supplied review sheet, not questions taken from the teacher's test.

19. Practice: government and analysis

Use precise vocabulary in every answer

13. Give one achievement and two weaknesses of the Articles of Confederation. Explain a consequence of one weakness.

14. Match each example to the correct law.

- A. Land is divided into 36 sections per township.
- B. A territory follows a process toward equal statehood.
- C. Section 16 supports public schools.

Choices: Land Ordinance of 1785; Northwest Ordinance of 1787.

15. Explain why Shays' Rebellion increased support for changing the national government.

16. The Great Compromise established:

- A. One vote per state in a single chamber. B. Representation based only on wealth.
- C. Equal representation in both chambers. D. A population-based House and an equal-state Senate.

17. Correct this statement: "The Three-Fifths Compromise gave three-fifths of enslaved people the vote."

18. Identify the principle in each example.

- A. Congress makes laws; the president carries them out; courts interpret them.
- B. The president vetoes a bill passed by Congress.
- C. National and state governments each exercise constitutionally allocated authority.
- D. Political authority ultimately comes from the people.

19. Correct this statement: "The House impeached the president, so the president was automatically convicted and removed."

20. Match each description to an amendment number.

- A. Peaceful assembly and petition. B. Unreasonable searches and seizures.
- C. Compelled self-incrimination. D. A speedy, public criminal trial and counsel.
- E. Civil jury trial. F. Cruel and unusual punishment.
- G. Unlisted rights retained by the people. H. Undelegated powers reserved.
- I. Keep and bear arms. J. Quartering soldiers in private homes.

21. A politician favors a national bank, a stronger federal government, and a broad interpretation of implied powers. Which early party is the better match, and why?

22. Explain why a supporter of the Constitution in 1788 did not necessarily support Hamilton's party in the 1790s.

23. Source analysis: The Mayflower Compact refers to a "civil body politic" and the "general good of the Colony." Explain one political idea these phrases illustrate and one limit on calling the settlement a modern democracy.

24. Write a 3-4 sentence claim about whether the colonies had become one American society by 1775. Include one force promoting unity and one continuing division.

Timed writing: Randomly choose one of the seven teacher prompts on pages 16-18. Spend about two minutes outlining your claim and evidence, then write the requested half-page response without consulting the model.

20. Answer key: 1-12

Use the explanation to diagnose mistakes

1. **B.** The central distinction is separation from the Church of England versus reform. A reverses and distorts the beliefs; C gives the wrong colony and motive; D overstates equality and toleration.
2. **C.** The Compact joined its signers into a community with agreed rules. It retained loyalty to the king. It did not create the U.S. courts or abolish slavery.
3. **A.** New York, New Jersey, Pennsylvania, and Delaware are the four Middle colonies. The other choices mix regions.
4. **Sample answer:** New England's rocky soil and short growing season encouraged small farms plus fishing, shipping, and shipbuilding. Fertile Middle-colony land and navigable rivers supported grain production and commerce. The South's longer growing season supported cash crops and plantation agriculture. Give an actual causal connection, not just a region's name.
5. **D.** The French and Indian War left Britain with debt and expenses for defending its enlarged empire. A, B, and C place later American events before their time.
6. **B.** Stamp Act, 1765 -> Boston Tea Party, 1773 -> Lexington and Concord, 1775 -> Declaration, 1776. The other options misorder the escalation.
7. Price was only part of the issue. The tea still carried a duty imposed by Parliament without elected colonial representation, and the company's privileges threatened colonial merchants. Buying it could seem to accept Parliament's disputed power to tax.
8. The First Continental Congress in 1774 coordinated resistance to the Coercive Acts, including a boycott. The Second, beginning in 1775, directed the war effort, created the Continental Army, selected Washington, and later adopted independence.
9. **C.** Saratoga in 1777 demonstrated that the Americans could defeat a major British army and helped secure France's formal alliance in 1778. The Treaty of Paris ended the war; Lexington and Concord began fighting; the Bill of Rights came later.
10. **A.** Britain took the position, but its heavy losses encouraged Americans about their ability to resist. The battle was in 1775, before French alliance, Yorktown, and peace.
11. The French fleet prevented British reinforcement or evacuation by sea while American and French land forces besieged Cornwallis. The combination of land and naval pressure led to surrender in 1781.
12. The Declaration, adopted in 1776, asserted independence and explained its justification. The Treaty of Paris in 1783 formally ended the war between Britain and the United States and secured British recognition of independence. A declaration of a claim and another state's recognition of that claim are different events.

If you missed several questions here

Rebuild the sequence aloud: colonial differences -> British war debt -> taxes and restrictions -> organized protest -> armed conflict -> independence -> foreign alliance -> victory -> peace. Add one named event at every step.

21. Answer key: 13-24

Final distinctions to check before the test

- 13.** Achievement: land ordinances or diplomatic coordination. Weaknesses: inability to tax directly, weak commerce authority, lack of a separate executive, lack of a general federal judiciary, or difficult voting/amendment rules. Example consequence: unreliable state payments made paying war debts difficult.
- 14.** A and C: Land Ordinance of 1785. B: Northwest Ordinance of 1787. Remember surveying/selling versus governing/statehood.
- 15.** Armed debtor protests in Massachusetts exposed instability and increased fears that the national government could not respond effectively to major crises. This reinforced calls for stronger national authority and constitutional reform.
- 16. D.** House representation is based on population, while each state has two senators. A resembles equal-state representation in a one-house body; B and C do not describe the compromise.
- 17.** The compromise counted three-fifths of the enslaved population for apportionment of representation and direct taxation. It did not give enslaved people voting rights. Slaveholding states gained political power from people they denied political participation.
- 18.** A: separation of powers. B: checks and balances. C: federalism. D: popular sovereignty.
- 19.** Impeachment by the House brings formal charges. The Senate tries the case; conviction requires two-thirds of senators present and results in removal. Impeachment alone does not remove an official.
- 20.** A-1; B-4; C-5; D-6; E-7; F-8; G-9; H-10; I-2; J-3.
- 21.** Federalist Party. These positions match Hamilton's program of national fiscal power, a bank, and a broad reading of implied constitutional authority.
- 22.** Ratification concerned whether to adopt the new framework; later party disputes concerned how to use its powers. Madison supported ratification but later joined Jefferson in opposing Hamilton's program.
- 23.** The phrases illustrate an agreement to form a governing community whose rules serve shared welfare. A limit is that the agreement's participants were adult men, not an electorate including all residents; it also maintained royal allegiance. A strong answer links the language to the interpretation.
- 24. Sample answer:** By 1775, the colonies were developing a shared political identity, but they were not a uniform society. Boycotts and the Continental Congress helped unite resistance to British policies. However, regional economies and religions differed, and Loyalists opposed the Patriot cause. Cooperation against Britain therefore coexisted with important divisions.

Last five checks

1620: Compact, not independence. **1776:** Declaration, not Constitution. **1785/1787:** Land survey / territorial government. **1787/1789:** Constitution written / government begins. **1791:** Bill of Rights.

Say aloud: legislative makes, executive enforces, judicial interprets; federalism divides national/state power; checks and balances let branches limit each other.

22. Sources and class coverage

All ten supplied photos reviewed

The class review sheet determines the scope. Handwritten responses were treated as student notes to verify, not as an authoritative answer key. HEIC files were converted for visual reading after automatic Markdown extraction failed to recover their text.

Photo	Visible worksheet	Guide coverage
IMG_7200.HEIC	The U.S. Government	Convention compromises, branches, constitutional principles, corrected definitions: pp. 12-13
IMG_7201.HEIC	Unit 1 Review Sheet: U.S. Beginnings	Overall scope; all seven writing prompts: pp. 16-18
IMG_7202.HEIC	Articles of Confederation	Powers, weaknesses, Shays' Rebellion, Convention: pp. 10-12
IMG_7203.HEIC	The American Revolution	Required war events and corrected chronology: pp. 6-8
IMG_7204.HEIC	American and British Strengths and Weaknesses	Military comparison and supply/loyalty qualifications: p. 8
IMG_7205.HEIC	Road to Revolution, first page	Ideas, war debt, Sugar/Stamp Acts, Townshend duties: p. 5
IMG_7206.HEIC	Road to Revolution, second page	Boston events, Congress, fighting, Common Sense: pp. 6-7
IMG_7207.HEIC	The Mayflower Compact	Vocabulary, purpose, political ideas, limits: p. 2
IMG_7208.HEIC	3 Colonial Regions	All colonies, geography, economy, people, community: pp. 3-4
IMG_7209.HEIC	Colonial Regions, Part B	Similarities, differences, degree of unity: p. 4

Online references: settlement and resistance

Links are clickable in the PDF. Accessed September 23, 2026. These sources add background, verify dates and definitions, and correct worksheet shortcuts; the guide does not reproduce whole online articles.

[S1] Plimoth Patuxet Museums, [Mayflower and Mayflower Compact](#). Context and primary-source text.

[S2] National Park Service, [The Puritans](#). Beliefs and Massachusetts Bay.

[S3] National Park Service, [Separation of Church & State History](#). Religious authority and dissent.

[S4] Library of Congress, [Geography and Its Impact on Colonial Life](#). Regional comparison framework; class photos supply the comparison chart.

[S5] OpenStax, [U.S. History, 4.1: Charles II and the Restoration Colonies](#). Pennsylvania and later colonial settlement.

[S6] National Park Service, [Timeline of the Revolution](#). Event chronology and significance.

[S7] Office of the Historian, [Parliamentary Taxation, 1763-1775](#). Revenue measures and imperial conflict.

[S8] Library of Congress, [Religion in Eighteenth-Century America](#). Great Awakening context.

[S9] Library of Congress, [Revolution of the Mind](#). Intellectual background of independence.

[S10] National Park Service, [Boston Tea Party Timeline](#). Tea Act and destruction of the tea.

23. Online references, continued

War, founding documents, and political institutions

[S11] National Archives Museum, [First Continental Congress](#). Coordinated resistance in 1774.

[S12] Office of the Historian, [French Alliance, 1778](#). Diplomacy, recognition, and military support.

[S13] National Park Service, [What Happened at Valley Forge](#). Supply problems, training, and early French aid.

[S14] National Archives, [Treaty of Paris \(1783\)](#). Peace, recognition, and boundaries.

[S15] Independence Hall Association, [American and British Strengths and Weaknesses](#). Comparison of wartime advantages and challenges.

[S16] National Archives, [Declaration of Independence: Transcription](#). Primary document for rights, consent, grievances, and independence.

[S17] National Archives, [Articles of Confederation \(1777\)](#). Dates, state voting, national powers, and amendment rules.

[S18] George Washington's Mount Vernon, [Shays' Rebellion](#). Debt crisis and constitutional reform.

[S19] National Archives/DocsTeach, [Land Ordinance of 1785](#). Survey system and public land policy.

[S20] National Archives, [Northwest Ordinance \(1787\)](#). Territorial government, statehood, rights, and slavery provisions.

[S21] U.S. Senate, [The Virginia Plan, 1787](#). Virginia and New Jersey plans and the Great Compromise.

[S22] National Archives, [Constitution: Transcription](#). Articles I-III, representation, appointments, vetoes, impeachment, and federal powers.

[S23] National Archives, [Bill of Rights: Transcription](#) and [What Does It Say?](#). First ten amendments.

[S24] Library of Congress, [Establishing a Federal Republic](#). Jefferson, Hamilton, parties, and the national bank debate.

[S25] Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy, [Conservatism](#) and [Liberalism](#). Context for broad ideological terms; the classroom spectrum is a simplified comparison.

[S26] National Archives, [The Constitution: How Did It Happen?](#) and [The Bill of Rights: How Did It Happen?](#). Convention and ratification background; primary Articles text governs the powers summarized here.

[S27] United States Courts, [Court Role and Structure](#). Federal courts and checks and balances.

[S28] Congress, Constitution Annotated, [Overview of Incorporation of the Bill of Rights](#). Original federal scope and later application to states.